SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

14 November 2024 · Shift 1

76 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 14 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 11 questions

Q.2

Among three numbers, the second number is half of the first number and the third number is 4 less than the second number. If the average of the first and third numbers is 16, what is the second number?

(A) 12 **(B)** 10
(C) 18 **(D)** 16

Q.3

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 4% per year rate of interest for 5 years.

(A) 640 **(B)** 560
(C) 600 **(D)** 540

Q.4

After successive discounts of 26% and 22.5%, an item was sold at a profit of 24%. If the cost price of the item was ₹925, what was the marked price (in ₹) of the item?

(A) 1,975 **(B)** 2,000
(C) 2,200 **(D)** 2,250

Q.5

A class teacher conducted a unit test in the class. If out of 25 students, 11 students' average score is 77 and rest 14 students' average score is 69, then the weighted average score is:

(A) 68.54 **(B)** 72.52
(C) 74.65 **(D)** 70.29

Q.7

ABCD is a quadrilateral in which diagonal BD = 62 cm, AL $\perp$ BD and CM $\perp$ BD, such that AL = 14.3 cm and CM = 17.7 cm. The area of the quadrilateral ABCD is:

(A) 982 cm^2 **(B)** 900 cm^2
(C) 902 cm^2 **(D)** 992 cm^2

Q.10

Ravish had ₹1,500 with him. Sunaina had 24% more money than what Ravish had, while Sanatan had 10% less money that what Sunaina had. How much money did Sanatan have?

(A) ₹1,674 **(B)** ₹1,764
(C) ₹1,664 **(D)** ₹1,774

Q.11

A park has an average number of 420 visitors on Sunday and 120 on other days. The average number of visitors per day in a month of 30 days beginning with Sunday, is:

(A) 270
(B) 170
(C) 150
(D) 160

Q.12

When x is added to each of 2, 3, 30 and 35, then the numbers obtained in this order are in proportion. What is the second largest part in the proportion?

(A) 35
(B) 45
(C) 30
(D) 40

Q.13

The average of 20 results is 15 and the average of other 25 results is 24. What is the average of all the results?

(A) 40
(B) 22
(C) 39
(D) 20

Q.15

How long (in months) will it take a sum of money invested at 5% per annum on simple interest to increase its value by 22.5%?

(A) 48
(B) 44
(C) 50
(D) 54

Q.19

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 990
(B) 1010
(C) 1050
(D) 1090

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

In a code language, 'PARENT' is written as 'PWRANT' and 'SING' is written as 'SENG'. How will 'TERMINATE' be written in the same language?

(A) SARMENWTA
(B) TARMENWTA
(C) TERMANWTA
(D) SERMANWTA

Q.3

EJDI is related to CHBG in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, JOIN is related to HMGL. To which of the following is NSMR related, following the same logic?

(A) PQKL
(B) LQPK
(C) LQKP
(D) PQLK

Q.4

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts,decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All juices are burgers. Some burgers are chocolates. Conclusions: (I) Some burgers are juices. (II) Some juices are chocolates.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.5

In a certain code language, ‘MUST’ is coded as ‘7913’ and ‘TALE’ is coded as ‘8672’. What is the code for ‘T’ in the given code language?

(A) 7
(B) 3
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.7

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only 2 people sit between A and C when counted from the right of C. B sits 2nd to the left of C. F sits immediate on the right of D. E is not an immediate neighbour of C. Who sits immediate to the right of A?

(A) G
(B) E
(C) D
(D) F

Q.8

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 216 219 224 227 232 ?

(A) 233
(B) 235
(C) 234
(D) 236

Q.10

What will come in place of the question mark (?) of the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 15 + 9 ÷ 2 – 63 × 3 = ?

(A) 25
(B) 33
(C) 12
(D) 18

Q.11

In a certain code language, ‘rep sho pel’ means ‘goats are bleating’; ‘sho jin ken’ means ‘goats and cows’ and ‘met rep pi’ means 'dogs are mad'. What is the code for ‘are’ in that code language?

(A) sho
(B) pi
(C) rep
(D) met

Q.12

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 6 × 4– (60 ÷ 5) + 15 + (33÷ 3)× 2 = 59 (Note: Interchange should be done of entire number and not individual digits of a given number)

(A) 2 and 5
(B) 2 and 4
(C) 6 and 5
(D) 5 and 15

Q.13

8 is related to 33 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 11 is related to 45. To which of the following is 24 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 97
(B) 98
(C) 95
(D) 99

Q.14

EJ68 is related to OT55 in a certain way. In the same way, KP47 is related to UZ34. To which of the following is QV29 related, following the same logic?

(A) FA16
(B) AF20
(C) AF16
(D) FA20

Q.15

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). G sits to the immediate left of B. A sits to the immediate left of D. D sits second to the left of E. C sits third to the left of B. How many people sit between B and D when counted from the left of D?

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 1
(D) 4

Q.17

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 9, 43; 13, 63

(A) 18, 82
(B) 18, 83
(C) 17, 83
(D) 17, 82

Q.18

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? HKR, DGN, ZCJ ,VYF, ?

(A) RBK
(B) RUB
(C) RBY
(D) RFG

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'ZERO' is coded as '2468' and 'OILY' is coded as '5679'. What is the code for 'O' in that language?

(A) 9
(B) 6
(C) 8
(D) 5

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following is the legislative organ of the Union Government?

(A) State Executive
(B) Executive
(C) Judiciary
(D) Parliament

Q.2

Which type of coal is found in Damodar valley?

(A) Anthracite
(B) Peat
(C) Bituminous
(D) Lignite

Q.3

Which of the following are building blocks of proteins?

(A) Acids
(B) Bases
(C) Cells
(D) Amino acids

Q.4

In which the following sports do caddies play the role of helper for the player?

(A) Cycling
(B) Golf
(C) Shooting
(D) Boxing

Q.5

Under which category did Ricky Kej secure his third Grammy award?

(A) Best Immersive Audio Album
(B) Best Contemporary Instrumental Album
(C) Song of the year
(D) Best Audio Album of the year

Q.6

What is the total length of 'Atal Tunnel', which is located in Himachal Pradesh state?

(A) 9.5 kilometres
(B) 9.8 kilometres
(C) 9.02 kilometres
(D) 9 kilometres

Q.7

Who among the following is the author of the famous novel,'One Amazing Thing'?

(A) Sonali Dev
(B) Khushwant Singh
(C) Chitra Banerjee Divakurni
(D) Amitav Ghosh

Q.8

The 'Servants of India Society' was founded by which of the following freedom fighters?

(A) Chittaranjan Das
(B) Motilal Nehru
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Q.9

_____, which translates to 'dance of the enchantress,' stands out as one of the most captivating expressions in the Indian classical dance repertoire.

(A) Manipuri
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Mohiniyattam
(D) Kuttiyatam

Q.10

Who among the following Mughal emperors had a great interest in paintings?

(A) Humayun
(B) Babur
(C) Shahjahan
(D) Jahangir

Q.11

Which of the following states in India had the LOWEST poverty ratio in 2011-2012 as per the Economic Survey 2013-14, released by the Ministry of Finance, Government of India?

(A) Kerala
(B) Haryana
(C) Gujarat
(D) Karnataka

Q.12

According to the Indian calendar, the March and April months are known as _____.

(A) Asvina-Kartika
(B) Jyaistha-Asadha
(C) Chaitra-Vaisakha
(D) Magha-Phalguna

Q.13

Name the Sri Lankan Buddhist text that provides details of the Mauryan empire.

(A) Dipavamsa
(B) Divyavadana
(C) Ashokavadana
(D) Parishishtaparvan

Q.14

Which of the following statements about the Sangeet Natak Akademi is/are true? 1. The Sangeet Natak Akademi has been functioning as the apex body of the performing arts in the country. 2. The main objective of the Akademi is to coordinate and collaborate with the government and performing artists. 3. The Sangeet Natak Akademi comes under the Ministry of Culture of the government of India.

(A) 1, 2, and 3
(B) Only 2 and 3
(C) Only 1 and 2
(D) Only 1 and 3

Q.15

How much amount is provided per month as assistance to the female head of the family under the Gruha Lakshmi Scheme launched by the Karnataka Government in July 2023?

(A) ₹3,500
(B) ₹2,000
(C) ₹1,500
(D) ₹5,000

Q.16

What is the salt measurement in hypersaline lagoons?

(A) 30 to 35
(B) Less than 5
(C) Less than 100
(D) More than 100

Q.17

Who among the following became the Chairperson of the Parliamentary Committee on Science and Technology, Environment, Forests and Climate Change as on 30th September 2023?

(A) Jairam Ramesh
(B) Neeraj Shekhar
(C) Surendra Singh Nagar
(D) Satish Chandra Dubey

Q.18

Chhath Puja falls in which month of the Hindu calendar?

(A) Jyeshtha
(B) Kartika
(C) Ashadha
(D) Phalguna

Q.19

Which of the following is a NOT a feature of the Indian Parliamentary form of Government?

(A) Dissolution of the Lower House
(B) Leadership of the Prime Minister
(C) Majority party rule
(D) Non membership of the ministers in Legislature

Q.20

The Bara Imambara in Lucknow was built in the year 1784 by _____.

(A) Jahangir
(B) Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula
(C) Nawab Siraj-ud-Daula
(D) Akbar

Q.21

What is the process of a substance changing directly from a solid to a gas without passing through the liquid state called?

(A) Evaporation
(B) Fusion
(C) Condensation
(D) Sublimation

Q.22

Which of the following is the quality of the public goods?

(A) Non-rivalrous
(B) Rivalrous
(C) Excludable
(D) Non-divisible

Q.23
What is the player who sits at the centre of the rectangular field in Kho Kho called?

(A) Chaser
(B) Captain
(C) Master
(D) Defender

Q.24
Which of the following is the national fruit of Sri Lanka?

(A) Orange
(B) Strawberry
(C) Mango
(D) Jackfruit

Q.25
Shree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP), founded in 1903, to carry on the work of social reform was active in which of the following states?

(A) Assam
(B) Kerala
(C) Punjab
(D) Bihar

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given phrase. Jump on the bandwagon

(A) To oppose the idea of a group gaining popularity
(B) To support ideas that are less popular
(C) To join or support something which is gaining popularity
(D) To jump to a conclusion

Q.2
Select the option that rectifies the underlined spelling error. Participating in the “marthon” was a challenging experience.

(A) mereton
(B) marathon
(C) marethon
(D) merethon

Q.3
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who loves music

(A) Astrophile
(B) Chromatophilic
(C) Melophile
(D) Discophile

Q.4
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The Rungrado is the “large” football stadium in the world.

(A) most largest
(B) largest
(C) larger
(D) more larger

Q.5
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If we want to promote national integrity in our country, then we must desist our tendency of “taking up with” others.

(A) coming round
(B) setting out
(C) looking down upon
(D) bringing forward

Q.6
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Chauvinism
(B) Noctummbulism
(C) Alcoholism
(D) Somnambulism

Q.7
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Whimsical

(A) Confident
(B) Practical
(C) Illogical
(D) Fickle

Q.8
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Mahira is an more efficient" and hardworking employee of her company.

(A) No substitution required
(B) Mahira is an efficient
(C) Mahira is the efficient
(D) Mahira is the more efficient

Q.9
Select the most appropriate option to fill the blank. The strike, that the truck association called, caused a minor _____ of food in our village.

(A) less
(B) dearth
(C) leak
(D) availability

Q.10
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The company implemented a new _____ to improve efficiency.

(A) stratagy
(B) strateji
(C) strategie
(D) strategy

Q.11
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pay off old scores

(A) To be successful
(B) To have one's revenge
(C) To clear one's debt
(D) To score good marks

Q.12
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word to fill in the blank. Desist Every Indian should ____ from acts of corruption.

(A) pledge
(B) show
(C) insist
(D) refrain

Q.13
Select the most appropriate option with the correct usage of the preposition to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. UNESCO's mission is to contribute to the building of a culture of peace, the eradication of poverty, sustainable development and "intercultural dialogue with education", the sciences, culture, communication and information.

(A) intercultural dialogue from education
(B) intercultural dialogue through education
(C) intercultural dialogue in education
(D) intercultural dialogue by education

Q.14
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Avoid

(A) Evade
(B) Pursue
(C) Reflect
(D) Accept

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Indian Meteorological Department (IMD) had _____ that the city would witness rainfall on Thursday.

(A) contest
(B) prolong
(C) forecast
(D) manifest

Q.16

Select the grammatically correct sentence.

(A) The carpenter kept furniture in the backyard of his house.
(B) The carpenter kept the furniture in a backyard of his house.
(C) The carpenter kept the furniture in backyard of his house.
(D) The carpenter kept a furniture in the backyard of his house.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Where have you _____ all this time?

(A) bine
(B) been
(C) bean
(D) bin

Q.18

Select the most appropriate homonym to fill in the blank. During the _____ of Queen Victoria, England made all-round progress.

(A) rain
(B) rein
(C) reign
(D) rhine

Q.19

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. John searched thoroughly but could not find his coat nowhere in the house.

(A) but could not
(B) John searched thoroughly
(C) nowhere in the house.
(D) find his coat

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We should always _____ our best to help others.

(A) done
(B) do
(C) did
(D) does

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our (1)_____ revolve around our work. For the most part, males have to labour with their hands in order to (2)_____ themselves. But everyone needs to work in some (3)_____. It provides honour and credit to us. Nothing in life can be accomplished without it. Man is great only because of his labours. (4)_____ comes from work. The secret to success is this. Nobody can advance without labour. It truly is the (5)_____ idea of existence. Without it, life is even less meaningful.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) creatures
(B) mortals
(C) lives
(D) histories

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our (1)_____ revolve around our work. For the most part, males have to labour with their hands in order to (2)_____ themselves. But everyone needs to work in some (3)_____. It provides honour and credit to us. Nothing in life can be accomplished without it. Man is great only because of his labours. (4)_____ comes from work. The secret to success is this. Nobody can advance without labour. It truly is the (5)_____ idea of existence. Without it, life is even less meaningful.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) support
(B) bear
(C) promote
(D) embrace

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our (1)_____ revolve around our work. For the most part, males have to labour with their hands in order to (2)_____ themselves. But everyone needs to work in some (3)_____. It provides honour and credit to us. Nothing in life can be accomplished without it. Man is great only because of his labours. (4)_____ comes from work. The secret to success is this. Nobody can advance without labour. It truly is the (5)_____ idea of existence. Without it, life is even less meaningful.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) measurement
(B) magnitude
(C) volume
(D) capacity

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our (1)_____ revolve around our work. For the most part, males have to labour with their hands in order to (2)_____ themselves. But everyone needs to work in some (3)_____. It provides honour and credit to us. Nothing in life can be accomplished without it. Man is great only because of his labours. (4)_____ comes from work. The secret to success is this. Nobody can advance without labour. It truly is the (5)_____ idea of existence. Without it, life is even less meaningful.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Boast
(B) Remedy
(C) Shame
(D) Glory

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our (1)_____ revolve around our work. For the most part, males have to labour with their hands in order to (2)_____ themselves. But everyone needs to work in some (3)_____. It provides honour and credit to us. Nothing in life can be accomplished without it. Man is great only because of his labours. (4)_____ comes from work. The secret to success is this. Nobody can advance without labour. It truly is the (5)_____ idea of existence. Without it, life is even less meaningful.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) uproar
(B) secondary
(C) fundamental
(D) demean

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (A) 12

With the second number x, the first is 2x and the third x − 4. (2x + x − 4)/2 = 16, so 3x = 36 and x = 12.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 600

SI = 3,000 × 4 × 5/100 = ₹600.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 2,000

SP = 925 × 1.24 = ₹1,147. The two discounts leave 0.74 × 0.775 = 0.5735 of the marked price, so MP = 1,147/0.5735 = ₹2,000.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 72.52

(11 × 77 + 14 × 69)/25 = (847 + 966)/25 = 1,813/25 = 72.52.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 992 cm²

Area = ½ × BD × (AL + CM) = ½ × 62 × (14.3 + 17.7) = 31 × 32 = 992 cm².

Q.10 · Answer (A) ₹1,674

Sunaina had 1,500 × 1.24 = ₹1,860, and Sanatan 1,860 × 0.9 = ₹1,674.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 170

A 30-day month beginning on a Sunday has 5 Sundays (days 1, 8, 15, 22 and 29): (5 × 420 + 25 × 120)/30 = (2,100 + 3,000)/30 = 170.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 35

(2 + x)/(3 + x) = (30 + x)/(35 + x) gives (2 + x)(35 + x) = (3 + x)(30 + x), so 70 + 37x = 90 + 33x and x = 5. The numbers are 7, 8, 35 and 40; the second largest is 35.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 20

(20 × 15 + 25 × 24)/45 = (300 + 600)/45 = 20.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 54

A 22.5% gain at 5% a year takes 22.5/5 = 4.5 years = 54 months.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 1050

SI = 2,500 × 7 × 6/100 = ₹1,050.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) TARMENWTA

Consonants stay and each vowel moves 4 places back: A → W, E → A, I → E (PARENT → PWRANT, SING → SENG). So TERMINATE → TARMENWTA.

Q.3 · Answer (C) LQKP

Each letter moves 2 places back: E → C, J → H, D → B, I → G, and JOIN → HMGL the same way. So N → L, S → Q, M → K, R → P: LQKP.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows

All juices are burgers, so some burgers are juices (I). The burgers that are chocolates need not include any juice, so II does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 7

T is the only letter in both words and 7 the only digit in both codes, so T = 7.

Q.7 · Answer (B) E

B is second to C's left and A has two people between it and C on C's right. F on D's right then puts D next to C, and E, not beside C, takes the seat on A's right: going round to each person's left the order is C, G, B, E, A, F, D.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 235
The differences alternate +3, +5: 232 + 3 = 235.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 18
After interchanging: 15 – 9 × 2 + 63 ÷ 3 = 15 – 18 + 21 = 18.

Q.11 · Answer (C) rep
'are' is the only word common to the first and third sentences, and 'rep' the only code common to both, so are = rep.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 2 and 4
Interchanging 2 and 4: 6 × 2 – (60 ÷ 5) + 15 + (33 ÷ 3) × 4 = 12 – 12 + 15 + 44 = 59.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 97
The second number is four times the first plus 1: 8 × 4 + 1 = 33 and 11 × 4 + 1 = 45. Likewise 24 × 4 + 1 = 97.

Q.14 · Answer (C) AF16
Each letter moves 10 places forward and the number falls by 13: E → O, J → T, 68 → 55; K → U, P → Z, 47 → 34. So Q → A and V → F (wrapping round after Z), and 29 → 16: AF16.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 2
G is on B's immediate left and C third to B's left; D, second to E's left with A on its own left, fits only with E in the seat between G and C. Going round to each person's left: B, G, E, C, D, A, F. From D's left, A and F come before B: 2 people.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 17, 83
The second number is five times the first minus 2: 9 × 5 – 2 = 43 and 13 × 5 – 2 = 63. Likewise 17 × 5 – 2 = 83.

Q.18 · Answer (B) RUB
Every letter moves 4 places back each time, wrapping round from A to Z: H, D, Z, V, R; K, G, C, Y, U; R, N, J, F, B. The next cluster is RUB.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 6
O is the only letter in both words and 6 the only digit in both codes, so O = 6.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Parliament
Parliament (the President, the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha) is the Union's legislature; the executive and the judiciary are the other two organs.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Bituminous
The Damodar valley coalfields, such as Jharia, Raniganj and Bokaro, hold Gondwana coal that is mostly bituminous, including the coking coal used for steel.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Amino acids
Proteins are chains of amino acids joined by peptide bonds.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Golf
In golf a caddie carries the player's clubs and advises on the course.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Best Immersive Audio Album
Ricky Kej's third Grammy, in 2023, was for Best Immersive Audio Album, for 'Divine Tides', shared with Stewart Copeland; his first two were for Best New Age Album.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 9.02 kilometres
The Atal Tunnel under the Rohtang Pass, opened in October 2020, is 9.02 km long.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Chitra Banerjee Divakurni
'One Amazing Thing' is a novel by Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni (spelt 'Divakurni' in the option).

Q.8 · Answer (D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
Gopal Krishna Gokhale founded the Servants of India Society in Pune in 1905 to train workers for national service.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Mohiniyattam
Mohiniyattam, Kerala's classical dance, takes its name from Mohini, the enchantress form of Vishnu.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Jahangir
Mughal painting reached its height under Jahangir, a keen patron and connoisseur whose court artists included Abul Hasan and Ustad Mansur.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Kerala
In the Tendulkar-method estimates for 2011-12 that the survey reports, Kerala's poverty ratio (about 7%) was lower than Haryana's (about 11%), Gujarat's (about 17%) and Karnataka's (about 21%).

Q.12 · Answer (C) Chaitra-Vaisakha
In the traditional Indian seasons, Vasanta (spring) spans the months Chaitra and Vaisakha, roughly March and April; Jyaistha-Asadha is about May-June, Asvina-Kartika September-October and Magha-Phalguna January-February.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Dipavamsa
The Dipavamsa and the Mahavamsa, Pali chronicles of Sri Lanka, describe Ashoka and the Mauryas. The Divyavadana and the Ashokavadana are Sanskrit Buddhist texts, and the Parishishtaparvan is Hemachandra's Jain work.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 1, 2, and 3
SSC's key gives all three. The Akademi describes itself as the apex body of the performing arts in the country and is an autonomous body under the Ministry of Culture; it pursues its objectives by coordinating and collaborating with the governments and art academies of the states, which statement 2 loosely restates.

Q.15 · Answer (B) ₹2,000
Karnataka's Gruha Lakshmi scheme pays ₹2,000 a month to the woman head of each eligible family.

Q.16 · Answer (D) More than 100
NCERT's Class 12 Biology gives the salt concentration (salinity, in parts per thousand) as less than 5 in inland waters, 30 to 35 in the sea and more than 100 in some hypersaline lagoons.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Jairam Ramesh
Jairam Ramesh, a Congress member of the Rajya Sabha, chaired the committee and was renominated to the chair when the committees were reconstituted in September 2023.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Kartika
Chhath Puja falls on the sixth day of the bright half of Kartika, six days after Diwali.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Non membership of the ministers in Legislature
In India's parliamentary system ministers must be members of Parliament (a non-member must become one within six months). Dissolution of the Lok Sabha, the Prime Minister's leadership and majority-party rule are all features of it.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula
Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula of Awadh built the Bara Imambara in Lucknow in 1784, partly as a famine-relief work.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Sublimation
Sublimation is the direct change from solid to gas, as with camphor, naphthalene or dry ice.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Non-rivalrous
Public goods are non-rivalrous (one person's use does not reduce what is left for others) and non-excludable.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Chaser
In kho-kho the chasing side's players sit in the squares of the central lane, facing alternate ways, while one active chaser pursues the defenders.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Jackfruit
SSC's key gives jackfruit, which is commonly listed as Sri Lanka's national fruit.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Kerala
Sree Narayana Guru founded the SNDP Yogam in 1903, with Dr Palpu, for the uplift of the Ezhavas of Kerala.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) To join or support something which is gaining popularity
To 'jump on the bandwagon' is to join or support something because it is becoming popular.

Q.2 · Answer (B) marathon
The correct spelling is 'marathon'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Melophile
A melophile is a lover of music. An astrophile loves stars, and a discophile collects gramophone records.

Q.4 · Answer (B) largest
Comparing one stadium with all others in the world calls for the superlative: 'the largest'. 'Most largest' doubles the superlative.

Q.5 · Answer (C) looking down upon
To 'look down upon' others is to regard them as inferior, the tendency that harms national integrity.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Noctummbulism
The correct spelling is 'noctambulism', sleepwalking, like 'somnambulism'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Practical
'Whimsical' means acting on sudden fancies; its opposite is 'practical'. 'Fickle' is close to a synonym.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Mahira is an efficient
'More' needs a comparison, and 'efficient' begins with a vowel sound: 'Mahira is an efficient and hardworking employee'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) dearth
A 'dearth' is a scarcity: the strike caused a shortage of food.

Q.10 · Answer (D) strategy
The correct spelling is 'strategy'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) To have one's revenge
To 'pay off old scores' is to take revenge for an old wrong.

Q.12 · Answer (D) refrain
To 'desist' is to stop doing something: to 'refrain', which also takes 'from'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) intercultural dialogue through education
UNESCO's mission statement speaks of 'intercultural dialogue through education, the sciences, culture, communication and information': these are the means by which the dialogue is built.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Evade
To 'avoid' something is to keep away from it: to 'evade' it.

Q.15 · Answer (C) forecast
The weather office had 'forecast', or predicted, rain.

Q.16 · Answer (A) The carpenter kept furniture in the backyard of his house.
'Furniture' is uncountable and takes no 'a', and the backyard of his house is a particular one, so 'the backyard': 'The carpenter kept furniture in the backyard of his house.'

Q.17 · Answer (B) been
'Have' takes the past participle 'been': 'Where have you been all this time?' 'Bean' and 'bin' only sound similar.

Q.18 · Answer (C) reign
A monarch's period of rule is a 'reign'; 'rain' and 'rein' sound the same but mean something else.

Q.19 · Answer (C) nowhere in the house.
'Not' and 'nowhere' make a double negative: 'could not find his coat anywhere in the house'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) do
A modal such as 'should' takes the base form of the verb: 'We should always do our best'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) lives
'Our lives revolve around our work': work is at the centre of our lives.

Q.22 · Answer (A) support
People labour with their hands to 'support' themselves, that is to earn their living.

Q.23 · Answer (D) capacity
'In some capacity' means in some role or position.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Glory
'Glory comes from work', in keeping with the honour and credit the passage says work brings.

Q.25 · Answer (C) fundamental
Work is the 'fundamental', or basic, idea of existence.

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